

CORZETTI ALLE ERBE

REGION North	SERVES 4-6	TOTAL TIME 1 h plus the dough rest
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INGREDIENTS

1 batch	Egg dough
60 g	Pine nuts
42 g	Olive oil
25 g	Garlic, very finely chopped
45 g	Unsalted butter, cold and cubed
20 g	Parsley, finely chopped
22 g	Parmigiano-reggiano, finely grated
5 g	Marjoram leaves

METHOD

- Stamp 80 corzetti from the egg dough.
- Heat the oven to 325°F. Scatter the pine nuts across a sheet pan in one layer and toast them 5 to 7 minutes to a very pale gold, looking in every couple of minutes so they do not catch. Let them cool about 15 minutes, then chop them coarsely.
- Salt a large pot of water heavily and bring it to a boil over high heat.
- Set a saute pan on the lowest heat you can manage. Add the garlic to the oil and cook 10 to 15 seconds, until aromatic but with no color on it. Pour in 2 ladles of pasta water (115 g), drop in the butter, swirl to emulsify, then pull the pan off the heat.
- Cook the corzetti 1 to 2 minutes, until just tender.
- Return the pan to low heat. Lift the pasta across with a spider or pasta basket, raise the heat to medium, and swirl 30 seconds to 1 minute to marry.
- Off the heat, stir the parsley and half the pine nuts gently through the sauce. A splash of pasta water loosens it if it tightens.
- Lay the pasta out on plates in a single layer. Spoon the sauce left in the pan over the top, then finish with the remaining pine nuts, the parmigiano and the marjoram.

NOTES

Walnuts work in place of pine nuts. That is the other Ligurian reading of the sauce, with the pine nut the more usual partner.

The marjoram goes on raw at the end rather than into the pan, which is a departure from the usual practice of cooking the herbs briefly in the sauce. Raw keeps the aroma forward.

The garlic should get no further than aromatic. Very low heat and 10 to 15 seconds, with no color on it.

Pine nuts turn fast. Pull them at a very light gold and check every few minutes while they are in the oven.

The whole sauce is built in the pan while the water comes up, so nothing here needs planning ahead beyond the dough.

SHAPE

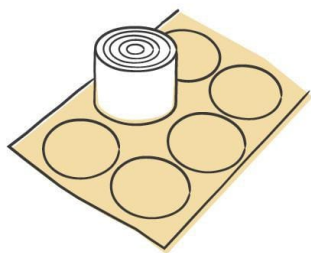
Corzetti

Region: Liguria / Rest: 15 to 20 minutes at room temperature

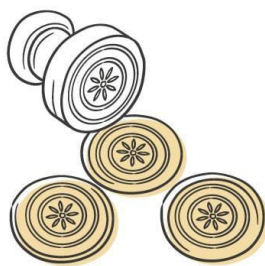
METHOD

- Make an egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
- Dust a wooden cutting board lightly with 00 flour. Set out a parchment-lined sheet pan, dusted lightly with semolina.
- Lay a sheet on the board. Cut coins with the hollow side of the corzetti stamp, spacing the cuts 1/8 inch apart.
- Turn the stamp over to the carved side and press it onto each coin. Press hard enough to leave a clear impression without flattening the disc. Dust one or both faces of the coin with 00 flour if it sticks in the stamp.
- Lay the stamped coins in a single layer on the pan. Separate additional layers with semolina-dusted parchment.
- Work through the remaining sheets the same way.
- Dry 15 to 20 minutes at room temperature. To hold, wrap the pan and refrigerate up to 24 hours.

SHAPING



1



2



3

NOTES

Requires a corzetti stamp — a carved wooden stamp, hollow on one face to cut the coin and carved on the other to imprint it.

Coins are cut 1/8 inch apart on the sheet.

If the stamp's cutting edge has dulled and no longer cuts cleanly, cut the coins with the ring from a set of round pastry cutters, then imprint with the stamp.

Two shapes share the name. The other is a figure-eight gnocco pressed with two fingers, called croset, crosit, or crosetti. This entry is the stamped coin, also called croxetti or corzetti stampati.

Keeps refrigerated up to 24 hours.

Served with herb sauces such as pesto, or with vegetables in season. A chestnut dough version is paired with mushrooms and parmigiano in winter.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.

Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.

Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.

Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____

RATING ____ / 5

OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____